"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 7

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

- According to the genealogical record found in Genesis 5, God caused the earth to flood approximately 1650 years after the world was created.

Characters:

- **Noah** – The son of Lamech. One of the few people on earth who honored God.
- **Noah's Wife** – According to Jewish tradition her name was Naamah (Gen 4:22).
- **Noah's Sons and Their Wives** – They accompanied Noah on the ark during the flood.

Where:

- The flood mentioned in this chapter was a worldwide flood. The water covered all the earth's dry land, even the mountains.

Outline:

- NOAH PREPARES FOR THE FLOOD (7:1-5):
    + Because Noah was righteous before God, God promised to keep him alive in the ark during the worldwide flood.
    + God also wanted to preserve many of His animal creations, so He told Noah to take 7 pairs of all "clean" animals into the ark along with one pair of all "unclean" animals.
    + God told Noah the flood was going to begin in 7 days, and it would rain continually for 40 days and 40 nights.
- THE FLOOD (7:6-24):
    + Noah was 600 years old when the earth was flooded.
    + Noah's wife, his sons, and his son's wives accompanied him on the ark.
    + God shut and sealed the door before the deluge started.
    + "In the second month, on the seventeenth day of the month, on that day all the fountains of the great deep burst forth, and the windows of the heavens were opened. And rain fell upon the earth..." (7:11-12).
    + The water rose so high the highest mountains were covered by at least 15 cubits.
    + "And all flesh died that moved on the earth, birds, livestock, beasts, all swarming creatures that swarm on the earth, and all mankind" (7:21).
    + The waters remained on the earth for 150 days.

Application:

- God is a God of love, but He is also a God of justice and holiness.
- This story should be a lesson to modern readers that God will judge sinful people.
- The suggestion that God will look past everyone's sins and extend love to everyone no matter how evil they've been isn't a biblical one.